While these stories may be apocryphal, the sheer volume of these popular tales demonstrates both the Padshah's appreciation for, and knowledge of, the Braj language and the Bhakti poets' resistance to appropriation by the rulers. The Brajbhasha sources also describe a more brittle reality that doesn't involve the sparkling magnificence of the court where Akbar was the faultless presence described by Abu'l Fazl. Dadu Dayal, for example, was a Bhakti poet of the sant tradition from Gujarat, who was an exact contemporary of Akbar. Dadu travelled to the Amer region of Rajasthan where Raja Bhagwant Das became a follower of the poet's message of inclusive love for all:

> He ignored all Muslim customs
> And abandoned Hindu practices
> He did not mix with other ascetics
> But stayed immersed in Ram day and night.

According to the Dadu's Hindi biography, Akbar was keen to meet with the saint and sent Abu'l Fazl and Raja Bhagwant Das to meet him first. When Abu'l Fazl questioned him on the nature of God and the worship due to him, the poet replied:

> Because He cannot be grasped, we call Him Allah,
> Because He cannot be described, we call Him Alakh.
> Because He created every thing, we call Him Sirjanhar,
> Because He is without end, we call Him Apar

When Dadu resisted going to meet the emperor on being summoned, Birbal tried to remonstrate with him:

> The king [Birbal] pointed out that the emperor is god
> incarnate (avatar)
> And that even Dadu should give him respect;
> 'he is looked at with great respect and worshipped
> as a god by both Hindus and Muslims'.
>
> Svamiji replied; 'I worship only One
> And do not bow to any other.
> All created beings are in the power of death,
> Only Brahma does not come or go.'